



GABY LUONG

Product Designer

PROFILE

I'm a Product Designer with graphic roots, and I help teams turn complex, messy products into systems people trust and use. Over 11 years across UX/UI, product design, and design systems, including 4 years running my own practice and over 3 years in-house at MDPI, I've shaped design direction, led UX research, and mentored designers across international teams in Switzerland, the UK, and the Netherlands. My print background shows up in how I build scalable, Figma-based design systems that keep complex products coherent, and in how closely I work with engineering to ship them.

CORE SKILLS

UX Research · Product Design · Design Systems · Interactive Prototyping · Customer Journey Mapping · Usability Testing · Stakeholder Management · Cross-Functional Collaboration · Accessibility · Data-Informed Design · AI Tools

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MDPI: Product Designer in Basel | May 2022 – October 2025

- Co-built MDPI's UX & Research team, growing it to four people, and embedded user-centred design practices across complex, API-driven platforms serving 55+ million monthly users.
- Translated complex technical requirements and data models into intuitive, user-friendly interfaces, addressing edge cases and reducing friction across core user journeys through workflow restructuring.
- Established UX standards, research processes, and design-review practices across multiple products to strengthen design quality and cross-functional alignment.
- Facilitated workshops and training sessions for Product, Engineering, Data/AI, and business stakeholders to align on product direction and design decisions.
- Coached designers across international teams, supporting their growth in UX research and design-system practice.

Redesign MDPI Books: Product Designer | 2023 – 2024

- Directed the end-to-end redesign of MDPI's academic publishing platform, building interactive prototypes that served as functional specifications for engineering implementation.
- Increased traffic threefold and reduced homepage drop-off from 83% to 22% within 6 months through iterative, data-informed design decisions, based on 7 interviews with academics and researchers.
- Established platform structure and component library in close collaboration with product managers and engineers.

SciProfiles / Scilit: Lead UX Research & Concept | 2024

- Conceptualized and scaled an international research platform for 1.1+ million users, built on an API-driven architecture in collaboration with engineering.
- Developed personas, customer journeys, and hypothesis-led product decisions in collaboration with AI and engineering teams.
- Facilitated international workshops to align distributed cross-functional teams and define product strategy.

MDPI User Hub: Lead UX Research | 2025

- Led UX research to understand why users left Susy, MDPI's highest-revenue product, right after login despite an NPS of about 50.
- Analysed usage data and mapped the customer journey with 2 personas, finding that 1 in 4 visits ended right after login.
- Facilitated seven moderated interviews with researchers, triangulating quantitative and qualitative data into 6 key behavioural patterns.
- Shaped a unified, role-aware dashboard concept and produced low-fidelity wireframes as the foundation for User Hub's design direction.

Unified Design System for MDPI: Brand/System Designer | 2020 – 2024

- Directed the design and rollout of a unified design system, unifying 8 previously fragmented initiatives across 17 global locations, replacing all legacy components with a 50+ component master system, informed by a perception survey with 80+ responses.
- Co-built a scalable Figma component system using Auto Layout, variants, and reusable components, adopted across all products.
- Produced component specs, redlines, and design tokens for engineering handoff, and reviewed shipped implementation against spec to ensure fidelity.

Self-Employed: Graphic, Art Direction & Product Designer in Amsterdam | November 2018 – May 2022

- Designed UX/UI and product solutions for international clients, including website architectures and design systems.
- Developed digital products and visual identities for selected projects, including the riso-printed Living Matters poster series and the MAMA documentary film.
- Freelanced for MDPI from 2020, which led to a full-time offer joining their in-house team in May 2022.

thonik (Freelance): Art Director & Graphic Designer | Amsterdam 2018, 4 months

- Collaborated on identity and editorial design projects for international clients, including the visual identity and catalogue design for the 2018 Shanghai Biennale at Power Station of Art, working directly with exhibiting artists.

G.A. Brand Design (Freelance): Graphic & Digital Designer | London 2018, 7 months

- Designed print and digital publications and infographics in the financial sector using Adobe Photoshop, InDesign and Illustrator, including brand projects for *American Express – Centurion*.

Victoria Beckham (Freelance): Graphic & Social Media Designer | London 2017, 3 months

- Created campaign materials, newsletters, and social media content. Organized and supported New York Fashion Week productions.

SPIN: Junior Designer UX/UI & Brand Identity | London September 2016 – November 2017

- Prepared production-ready UI specs and motion assets for the *Samsung Fashion & Design Fund* website, building reusable UI components for its two-tier designer showcase concept, and assisted with UX/UI and identity design for *BBC* and *Nike*.
- Designed the identity system for *Saatchi Gallery Collect* in collaboration with the Creative Director, applied across large-scale signage and printed wayfinding.

Yaay: internship Information Design Intern | Basel August 2015 – January 2016

- Developed information and signage design for the city Zurich.

EDUCATION

2024 – 2025	CAS Usability and User Experience, FHNW Olten, Switzerland
2016	Werkplaats Typografie, Summer Residency at ISIA Urbino, Italy
2013 – 2015	Bachelor of Arts in Visual Communication, FHNW HGK Basel, Switzerland
2012 – 2013	Vocational Baccalaureate in Design, AGS Basel, Switzerland
2011 – 2012	Foundation Course in Design, Basel, Switzerland
2005 – 2009	Business School Diploma, WMS KVBL Reinach, Basel-Landschaft, Switzerland

SKILLS

Design & Prototyping:	Figma (Auto-Layout, Components, Libraries), Miro, Adobe CC, Wireframing, Prototyping
UX & Research:	User Research, User Interviews, Usability Testing, Customer Journey Mapping, Information Architecture, Accessibility, Analytics
Systems & Strategy:	Design Systems, UX Strategy, Stakeholder Management, AI Tools (Figma AI)
Collaboration:	Jira, Confluence, Trello, SEO, Presentation and Client Communication

LANGUAGES

German/Swiss German	Native
Cantonese	Native
English	Fluent (8 yrs abroad) & C1
French	B2
Dutch	B1
Spanish	B1
Italian	B1

VOLUNTEER WORK

German Teacher | Basel January 2026 – present

Weekly lessons for migrant women to support language development and integration.

INTERESTS

In my free time, I enjoy cooking, practising BJJ, and cycling. I love exploring cities and museums with friends, and travelling to discover architecture around the world.